

HRGoTo HCM

HR Staff Training Guide

Practical Setup & Operations Manual

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Delivery	3 training sessions
Audience	HR Managers, Payroll Staff, Supervisors, All Staff

Confidential — For internal training purposes only

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Phase 1: System Setup (Trainer / Admin)

Step 1 — Environment & Installation

- Ensure server meets requirements: **PHP 8.3+**, MySQL/MariaDB, Apache with **mod_rewrite**, SSL certificate
- Create a MySQL database (e.g. *hrmis_db*)
- Copy project files to web root, edit **.env** with your DB credentials:
DB_HOST=localhost / DB_PORT=3306 / DB_DATABASE=hrmis_db / DB_USERNAME=root /
DB_PASSWORD=your_password
- Run **composer install --no-dev** to install TCPDF and PDFMerger dependencies
- Set Apache document root to the **public/** folder; enable **mod_rewrite**
- Verify **public/uploads/** and **public/uploads/offers/** exist and are writable
- Upload and profile photo uploads are limited to **10 MB** (configured in **public/.htaccess**)

Step 2 — Initial Login

TIP: Use the "Forgot Password" feature (requires SMTP configured) for self-service password resets.

- Open browser to **https://your-domain.com/login**
- Default credentials: a Super Admin account must be seeded directly in the database (INSERT INTO users with role_id pointing to the "Super Admin" role)
- After login, the **Dashboard** displays:
 - Notification bell (top-right) \u2014 click to view unread alerts
 - Profile menu (initials button) \u2014 Account Settings, Logout
 - Session timer \u2014 30-minute idle timeout with a warning at 25 minutes
- Sidebar adapts based on user role \u2014 Staff see only Staff Portal; HR sees admin tools

Phase 2: Foundation Data (HR Admin)

Step 3 — Company Profile

Navigate to **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Company Profile**.

- **Company Info:** Name, address, email, phone, SMTP settings for email notifications
- **Office Location:** Set GPS latitude/longitude and radius (meters) for attendance geo-fencing. Optionally add an IP whitelist so staff can clock in from specific networks.
- SMTP password field shows ********* \u2014 leave as-is to preserve the existing password; type a new value only to change it

Step 4 — Roles & Permissions

Navigate to **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Roles & Permissions**.

- Built-in roles: **Super Admin, HR Manager, Supervisor, Staff**
- Each user has exactly one role \u2014 this controls which menu items they see and which features they can access
- Super Admin and HR Manager have full access; Supervisors can review their supervisees; Staff access only their own data
- Add or rename roles as needed for your organization structure

Step 5 — Departments & Designations

- **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Departments** \u2014 Add departments (e.g. Finance, Academic Affairs, IT). Each department can have a parent unit for org hierarchy.
- **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Designations** \u2014 Add job titles (e.g. Senior Lecturer, Accountant, HR Officer). Designations describe the position, while ranks define salary grades.

Step 6 — Ranks & Salary Grades

Navigate to **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Ranks**.

- Define the promotion ladder (e.g. Lecturer \u2192 Senior Lecturer \u2192 Associate Professor \u2192 Professor)
- Each rank has a **base salary** amount \u2014 this is the foundation for payroll gross pay calculation
- Ranks are used in promotion workflows and payroll processing

Step 7 — Appraisal Metrics

Navigate to **Admin Tools** \u2192 **Appraisal Metrics**.

- Define measurable performance criteria e.g. Teaching Quality, Research Output, Punctuality
- Each metric can have a maximum score (e.g. 1\u20135)
- Staff score themselves; supervisors add their scores; HR Manager finalizes

- If you do not use appraisals, this step can be skipped

Step 8 — Create Users

TIP: Newly created users get a default password (set in code). Share credentials securely and instruct them to change on first login.

Navigate to **Admin Tools \u2192 Users**.

- **Single user:** Click "Add User" \u2192 enter full name, email, staff ID, role, department, designation, rank, and supervisor
- **Bulk import:**
 - Download the CSV template from **Staff \u2192 Staff List \u2192 Download CSV Template**
 - Fill in staff data using Excel or Google Sheets
 - Upload the CSV \u2192 preview the data \u2192 confirm import
 - System creates users and notifies via email if SMTP is configured
- Users can be toggled **active/inactive** using the Activate/Deactivate button in the Actions column
- Inactive users cannot log in

Phase 3: Staff Self-Service (Training Staff)

Step 9 — Staff Portal Orientation

- Staff log in at **<https://your-domain.com/login>**
- If they forget their password, click **Forgot Password** \u2014 a reset link is sent via email (requires SMTP)
- After login, the **Dashboard** shows:
 - **Notification bell** (top-right) \u2014 click to see unread alerts (leave approvals, promotion status, etc.)
 - **Profile menu** (initials circle) \u2014 Account Settings, Logout
- The sidebar menu shows only what is relevant to the Staff role

Step 10 — Profile & Documents

- **Staff Portal \u2014 My Profile** \u2014 view personal details, staff ID, department, designation, rank
- **Staff Portal \u2014 Update Info** \u2014 update phone, address, emergency contact, and upload a profile photo
- **Staff Documents** section (on profile page) shows uploaded documents from the dossier system

Step 11 — Leave Requests

- **Staff Portal \u2014 My Requests \u2014 Apply for Leave**
- Select leave type, start/end dates, provide a reason
- The request is routed to the staff member's **supervisor** for approval
- Status updates in real-time: Pending \u2014 Approved / Rejected
- Supervisors see pending requests under **Staff Portal \u2014 Approvals**

Step 12 — Promotion Requests

- **Staff Portal \u2014 My Requests \u2014 Request Promotion**
- Select current rank, requested rank, and upload supporting document (PDF, JPG, PNG)
- Workflow: Staff submits \u2014 Supervisor reviews/comments \u2014 HR Manager approves/rejects
- Status is visible in real-time; notification sent on approval

Step 13 — Self-Appraisal

- **Staff Portal \u2014 My Requests \u2014 Self Appraisal**

- Select the appraisal period, score yourself on each defined metric (1\u20135 scale)
- Supervisor reviews the self-score and adds their own assessment
- HR Manager finalizes the appraisal
- Download the completed appraisal as a **PDF** from the appraisals page

Step 14 — Attendance Clock-In/Out

- **Staff Portal \u2192 My Attendance**
- Click **Clock In** \u2014 records timestamp with GPS coordinates
- Must be within the office radius (configured in Company Profile), otherwise clock-in is rejected
- Click **Clock Out** at end of shift
- Attendance register and reports available to HR under **Admin Tools \u2192 Attendance**

Phase 4: Payroll Processing (HR Manager / Payroll Staff)

Step 15 — Payroll Setup

Before running payroll, complete these setup steps:

- **Payroll \u2192 Components** \u2014 Define earnings (e.g. Housing Allowance, Transport Subsidy) and deductions (e.g. Loan Repayment, Union Dues). Each component has a type (earnings or deduction)
- **Payroll \u2192 Employee Components** \u2014 Assign components to individual staff with specific amounts
- **Payroll \u2192 Benefits** \u2014 Create benefit types (percentage e.g. 10% of base salary, or fixed amount) and assign to employees (e.g. Risk Allowance, Research Grant)
- **Payroll \u2192 Bank Details** \u2014 Staff enter their bank account info. HR can view and export for bank transfer

Step 16 — Create Pay Period

- Navigate to **Payroll \u2192 Periods**
- Click **Create Period** \u2014 enter start date and end date
- The system auto-generates a period label (e.g. "July 2026")
- Once a period is **closed**, it cannot be re-run \u2014 this prevents accidental duplicate payroll runs

Step 17 — Run Payroll

NOTE: Payroll uses Ghana-specific tax rules. SSNIT employer contribution (13%) is tracked separately. Adjust brackets in the code if tax rates change.

- **Payroll \u2192 Process Payroll** \u2014 select a period from the dropdown
- Click **Run Payroll** for all employees, or filter by department and run for individuals
- **Calculation order:**
 1. Gross Pay = rank base salary + assigned components + assigned benefits
 2. SSNIT Employee = 5.5% of gross pay
 3. Taxable Income = gross pay \u2014 SSNIT employee
 4. PAYE Tax = computed from Ghana GRA monthly tax brackets (iterative calculation)
 5. Loan Deductions = employee-specific assigned deduction amounts
 6. **Net Pay** = gross pay \u2014 SSNIT \u2014 PAYE \u2014 loan deductions
- Results are stored in the **payroll_runs** table. Re-running the same period **updates** existing rows (does not duplicate)

Step 18 — Payslips & Reports

- **Payroll \u2192 Payslips** \u2014 Search by staff name/ID, view individual payslips, download as **PDF**
- **Payroll \u2192 Reports** \u2014 Summary by period and department. Export to Excel or CSV with DataTable buttons
- **Bank Transfer Report** \u2014 CSV file ready for bank upload (contains staff name, bank, account)

number, net pay)

- **Benefits Report** \u2014 CSV of all employee benefit assignments
- **Analysis & Forecast** \u2014 Chart.js dashboard: department cost trends, budget projection, attrition cost analysis

Phase 5: Recruitment (HR Manager)

Step 19 — Job Postings

- **Recruitment \u2192 Jobs** \u2014 Create job postings: title, department, description, requirements, salary range
- Jobs appear on the **public applicant portal** at <https://your-domain.com/apply>
- Applicants can view open positions and submit applications with education and experience details
- Applications flow into the recruitment pipeline for review

Step 20 — Application Rounds

- **Recruitment \u2192 Rounds** \u2014 Define screening stages for each job (e.g. Application Review \u2192 Written Test \u2192 Interview \u2192 Offer)
- Each round can have a **passing score** threshold
- Rounds are reusable across jobs; assign them per job posting

Step 21 — Manage Pipeline

- **Recruitment \u2192 Pipeline** \u2014 Kanban board showing all applicants grouped by stage
- **Move applicant:** Click status buttons (Pending \u2192 Under Review \u2192 Shortlisted \u2192 Interviewed \u2192 Offered \u2192 Hired/Rejected)
- **Schedule Interview:** Set date, time, type (in-person/virtual), interviewer, location
- **Send Offer:** Enter offered salary, upload offer letter (PDF/DOC), system logs it and notifies admins
- **Status History:** Click to view full audit trail with timestamps and user who made each change
- **Add Note:** Internal notes visible to the HR team

Phase 6: Communications

Step 22 — Email Campaigns

- **Email \u2192 Send Email \u2014** Compose and send to individuals, departments, or all staff
- **Email \u2192 Templates \u2014** Save reusable templates for common announcements (payroll notifications, policy updates, etc.)
- Email delivery requires SMTP to be configured in Company Profile

Step 23 — SMS Campaigns

- **SMS Dashboard \u2014** View API balance, configure campaign templates
- **Bulk SMS \u2014** Send to targeted groups by department, designation, or custom field
- Requires an SMS API provider to be configured (see developer for provider setup)
- If no API key is configured, SMS features will be inactive

Phase 7: Reports & Maintenance

Step 24 — Key Reports

Report	Location	Format
Staff List with ID Cards	Staff \u2192 Staff List	PDF, CSV
Dossier (full profile)	Profile \u2192 Download Dossier	PDF (merged)
Attendance Register	Admin \u2192 Attendance \u2192 Register	CSV, Excel
Payroll Summary	Payroll \u2192 Reports	CSV, Excel
Bank Transfer File	Payroll \u2192 Bank Transfer Report	CSV
Benefits Report	Payroll \u2192 Benefits \u2192 Report	CSV
Audit Logs	Admin Tools \u2192 Audit Logs	Table view
Recruitment Report	Recruitment \u2192 Compile Report	PDF
Payroll Analysis	Payroll \u2192 Analysis & Forecast	Chart.js dashboard

Step 25 — Housekeeping

REMINDER: Regularly back up your database. The system does not include an automated backup feature.

- **Session timeout:** 30 minutes idle; warning at 25 minutes with a "Stay Logged In" button. Clicking anywhere on the page resets the timer.
- **Password reset:** Via the "Forgot Password" flow (requires SMTP configured)
- **Audit logs:** All significant actions (user creation, payroll run, status changes) are logged with timestamp and user identity
- **ID Card Config:** Customize the ID card layout (logo, colors, fields shown) under **Admin Tools \u2192 ID Card Config**
- **Flash messages:** Success/error messages appear at the top of pages after actions. If they do not show, check that `$suppressGlobalFlash` is not enabled without a local flash include.

Training Flow Recommendation

Deliver the training in **three sessions**. Use a **sandbox database** so staff can experiment safely without affecting production data.

Session	Duration	Audience	Topics
1 \u2014 Admin Foundation	2 hours	HR Manager, IT Admin	Steps 1\u2013138: Setup, users, departments, ranks, appraisal metrics
2 \u2014 Staff Self-Service	1.5 hours	All staff	Steps 9\u20131314: Portal, profile, leave, promotion, appraisal, attendance
3 \u2014 Payroll & Recruitment	2.5 hours	Payroll staff, HR team	Steps 15\u20131324: Payroll, recruitment, reports, communications

Session Format

For each session: **Live demo** \u2013 **Hands-on practice** \u2013 **Q&A**. Allow staff to follow along in their own accounts on the sandbox.

Pre-Training Checklist

- Verify the system is installed and accessible from all training computers
- Prepare a sandbox database pre-loaded with sample data (fake staff, departments, etc.)
- Create training user accounts for each attendee
- Ensure the training room projector/display works with the browser
- Have printed copies of this guide available (or share the PDF beforehand)

End of Training Guide